

4.4 Assessment information

What the student will need to produce

Part A: An extended essay which addresses the question which was posed as the focus of the enquiry. The enquiry must provide evidence of students' ability to:

- assess the significance of their chosen individual or event in the short term
- interpret, evaluate and use sources in their historical context.

Part B: An extended essay which addresses the question which was posed as the focus of the enquiry.

The enquiry must provide evidence of students' ability to:

- identify relevant issues and make use of relevant reading and other data as appropriate in pursuit of the enquiry
- assess the significance of the chosen factor or event in the long term by linking the chosen factor, individual or event with other events and forces for change in the period.

Students are encouraged to make use of ICT in the production of both Parts A and B of the assignment.

Resource record

During the enquiry process the student will be responsible for completing a record of the resources used, a template for which is included in the Getting Started guide.

The student's resource record must:

- show the issues identified in pursuing the enquiry
- record the contemporary sources used
- record the secondary reading completed and the use of other data as appropriate.

The resource record will not be separately assessed but will validate the enquiry process and will provide evidence to support teacher judgements of the quality of the work. No word limit is attached to the resource record.

Word limits

The maximum word length of the total assignment is 4000 words. While a precise total limit is not attached to its constituent parts, students are advised to devote approximately 2000 words to each part.

It is the centre's responsibility to inform students that there is no tolerance on the prescribed word limit. Students are required to include a cumulative word count at the bottom of each page. Teacher-assessors and moderators will discontinue marking once the prescribed word limit is reached.

The role of the teacher

Teachers need to be able to sign the **authentication statement** (available on the Edexcel website and in the Getting Started guide for each and every student. 'Acceptable assistance' means that while it is legitimate, for example, to draw out the meaning of a question or to elucidate qualities required in the general level descriptors, it is **not** legitimate to:

- supply specific wording or phrases for students to include in their answer
- supply detailed question-specific writing frames or other structures to support an answer
- give detailed guidance on how to structure introductions or conclusions
- tell students in precise detail how to improve their assignment.

This means that it is **not permissible for drafts of work to be taken in, commented on, marked and then returned to students for revision**. The ability to redraft work after advice is not one of the skills being tested in the specification.

Validation

All completed coursework assignments must be accompanied by a statement that the completed assignment is the student's own unaided work, signed by the student and the supervising teacher. This should be included on the authentication sheet which can be found on the Edexcel website and in the Getting Started guide. Edexcel reserves the right to call in the coursework of all students.

The marking of coursework

Coursework will be assessed by the teacher and moderated by Edexcel.

The coursework of each student must be marked out of a total of 50 marks. The teacher must add together the marks for Part A and Part B and submit one mark to Edexcel.

The level descriptions for coursework assignments included on pages 96–102 **must** be used. These level descriptions **must not** be altered by teacher-assessors, but should be interpreted in relation to the content outlined in the centre's coursework programme.

Teachers are expected to mark the assessment objectives AO1 and AO2 separately for Part A.

The allocation of marks for this unit is as follows:

Part A: AO1 — 13 marks
 AO2 — 12 marks

Part B: AO1 — 25 marks.

The moderation of coursework

The marks submitted to Edexcel for coursework will be moderated in accordance with the requirements of the GCE Code of Practice.

An approved moderator will be assigned to each centre by Edexcel. They will be responsible for standardising marks across several centres.

Centres must ensure that there is full and effective internal standardisation of the assessments made by different teachers and of different teaching groups within a centre. This will establish an overall order of merit for all students in the centre. Centres are required to ensure that internal moderation (standardisation) has taken place. Standardisation within the centre must involve an examination of the students' work to ensure that the assessment criteria have been consistently applied. This process should also include an arithmetical check of the marks and the transfer of the correct marks to the Optical Teacher Examiner Mark Sheets (OPTEMS).

Final moderation will be conducted by post. Edexcel will specify which students' work will be required for moderation; further samples of work may be requested by the moderator. The moderation will consist of a detailed scrutiny of the sampled work in relation to marks awarded. (All other coursework materials must be retained, for possible use in moderation and in enquiries about results, until 30 September after the moderation period.)

The material to be used for moderation must be available on a date to be specified by Edexcel.

It will consist of:

- the completed Optical Teacher Examiner Mark Sheets (supplied by Edexcel listing the students entered)
- the record sheet for each student
- the marked coursework of each student included in the sample, plus teachers' notes listing any assistance given
- a copy of the Coursework Programme Approval form (for centre-designed coursework assignments; this must be signed as approved by Edexcel).

Normally, moderation will not affect the order of merit established by a centre. However, Edexcel will take appropriate action in cases where there is evidence of inconsistent assessment, or any other departure from specification requirements, in order to align standards. If necessary, such centres will be directed to review their assessment before moderation can be completed.

Edexcel will provide centres with the results of moderation of their coursework assessments as soon as possible after the examination. A moderator's report on the assessment will be sent to each centre.

Centres are strongly advised to ensure that the centre or the student keeps a copy of the work submitted for moderation.

Information about the moderation procedures will be sent to centres making entries for this specification. For further information on coursework moderation procedures, please refer to the Edexcel Information Manual which is sent to centres each year and to the Edexcel Online website (www.edexcelonline.org.uk).